



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Financial Analysis

PRINCIPLES OF FINANCE EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- “The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation.”
- “You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge).”
- “You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event.”
- “Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event.”

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the role of finance in business.
2. Describe the need for financial information.
3. Describe the nature of budgets.
4. Make responsible financial decisions.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a budget analyst at CITY PARKS, a nonprofit organization focused on maintaining and enhancing public parks and recreational areas in your community. The executive director (judge) has requested a presentation for the board of directors about the organization's budgeting process and its impact on community projects.

The executive director (judge) wants to understand how budget decisions influence the effectiveness of programs and community engagement. In your presentation, you should cover the following points:

- Overview of the budgeting process at CITY PARKS, including how budgets are developed and approved.
- The importance of financial forecasting in planning for future community projects and park improvements.
- Specific examples of how budget allocations have impacted recent projects, such as new playground installations or park clean-up events.
- Recommendations for improving the budgeting process to better align with community needs and expectations.

You will present your analysis to the executive director (judge) in a role-play that takes place in the executive director's (judge's) office. The executive director (judge) will begin the meeting by asking you to share your insights. After you have presented your information and answered the executive director's (judge's) questions, the executive director (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your contributions.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What tools or methods do you use for financial forecasting, and how do you ensure that predictions are accurate and aligned with community needs?
2. What are some common challenges you encounter during the budgeting process, and how do you overcome them?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the role of finance in business.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Describe the need for financial information.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Describe the nature of budgets.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Make responsible financial decisions.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
5.	Unique Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	Practical Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Effective Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
8.	Critical Thinking Think critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	Communication Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Decision Making Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
11.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
TOTAL SCORE						